

Made for us, or made for US?

Stop buying
fast, start
buying smart

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India is not at the forefront of global technology. No matter how patriotic you think you are, or how offended you get, it's true. Understanding why the global giants design products for the US instead of us, is not exactly rocket science.

It's all just a question of economics, actually. Build a product for a first-worlder, and when enough third-worlders begin clamouring for it, sell it there as well... Nothing wrong with selling products, of course. What matters is when they push products on to countries that cannot really utilise a lot of the features that first-worlders can. Of course not everyone does this, but it happens enough to warrant a closer look.

The release date circus

Hollywood did it because they think of us as a bunch of pirates, manufacturers do it because there's a buck and a half to be made. Most enthusiasts grin from ear-to-ear when they hear about a product launch date in India being within a week or two of its international launch. And we pay premium for it!

Entertainment machines?

We don't get 400 HD channels here. Heck we barely get 4 worth watching. Still, we do get almost every big name brand selling their TVs here. We're out there blindly buying all the 'Smart', 'HD' and even '3D' models we can lay our hands on, never

once wondering what we're going to use it for. If your wallet has a direct pipeline into a bank you can buy a lot of 3D Blu-ray content from abroad and have it shipped here, but if you're regular folk like us, depending on your neighbourhood rental store, best of luck finding something in 3D Blu-ray that you actually want to watch!

And don't even get us started on DTH HD – where else in the world will you find terms such as “asli HD” because loopholes allow people to make asses of you? As for the smart bit in smart TVs, we just don't have the requisite bandwidth for those to make any sense, but hey, go ahead and pay lakhs for one! Take even NetFlix and Hulu for example, manufacturers are busy pushing SMART TVs our way featuring

theses very same services. The true facts? These services don't work in India. Oh you can find a way to bypass the region restrictions and all, but that is not the point. These services only make any real sense in the US.

Game goodness

Licensing is a curse. And then they wonder why we're a country of software pirates. Many of the games we actually want may not come here, and those that do, will have severe DRM protection issues. Why should you need to be connected to the internet to play a single player game. Better yet, what is the point if you're suffering from server lag in that very same game (Diablo 3 for example). Take Free-2-Play games, they're quite good, give many paid games a run for their money and more importantly, are free! This looks like the perfect model for the Indian market but you're wrong. These Free-2-Play games come with a cost, not the optional cost of buying stuff in-game, the cost of requiring and maintaining a high-speed, low-latency internet connection. A rarity for most Indians and to top it off, we may not even find servers in our country and as any gamer would have found out, playing on Western servers is a very laggy experience.

Prices

Our mad craze to import the latest electronic devices from the West is mainly because of the subsidized prices that exist there. Here, you'd be lucky to get it at just double that



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